But Mistry continued to stonewall efforts to finalize the notice to be sent to shareholders to hold the EGM. Faced with this dilemma, Tata Sons decided to replace him through a circular resolution and appoint O.P. Bhatt as the interim chairman. The board meeting was fixed at 3 p.m. on 25 November, giving enough time to get the approvals from the members in the first half of the day. The meeting was fraught. Both Mistry and Wadia were furious.

Mistry said, 'I do not agree with the resolution.' Wadia was less retrained. He was 'frothing', and said, 'This is absolutely atrocious,' recalls Hussain. He took out his frustration on Bhatt and attacked him personally. 'You do not have the stature to be the chairman of Tata Steel,' Wadia told him to his face, Narendran recalls. 'Bhatt handled it with great equanimity,' he adds. The resolution was passed with a majority of seven and the board resolved to hold the EGM of the company on 21 December.

On the same day, Tata Sons also moved a circular resolution seeking approval of board members to replace Mistry in TGBL. The resolution was proposed by its CEO and MD Ajoy Misra and CFO L. Krishnakumar. The circular was passed, Mistry was removed with effect from 15 November and Harish Bhat appointed in his place.

The next board meeting was that of Tata Power on 29 November. Surprisingly, unlike all other board meetings held after Mistry's removal and until now, Mistry was restrained here. He chaired the board meeting for nearly four hours 'without any contest', wrote a leading journal. Towards the end of the meeting, he strategically stepped out and the notice that Tata Sons had sent out on 22 November advising the company to hold an EGM on 26 December to consider Mistry's removal from the company board was taken up. The board adopted the resolution to hold the EGM as advised by Tata Sons.

Mistry's Missive

By the beginning of December 2016, Mistry was no longer chairman of three companies (TCS, Tata Steel and TGBL). Tata Sons had issued notices to seven companies (TCS, TTSL, IHCL, Tata Steel, Tata Motors, Tata Chemicals and Tata Power) to hold EGMs for his replacement and, in some cases, replace both Wadia and him as directors.